

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager for large-scale consumer mobile.*

Positioning, 13 years owning product in regulated industries, from national-scale public-sector analytics to healthcare mobile apps, now ready to bring that depth to Abu Dhabi.

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§ WHY HALIAN / THIS ROLE

Leading the product vision for a consumer mobile application serving millions of users inside a highly regulated environment is precisely the intersection I have been building toward across my career. The posting calls out something specific and important: this is a strategic leadership role, not a delivery execution seat, with delivery teams already in place. That distinction matters, because it maps exactly to how I work best, setting the direction, shaping the roadmap around measurable outcomes, and leaving the day-to-day execution authority with the teams closest to the work. The mention of data privacy, governance, and compliance-driven product development in a government-backed context resonates directly with my time at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, where I held the deputy IT security officer mandate alongside roadmap ownership. *That combination of strategic ambition and regulatory rigour is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

The posting flags healthcare experience as beneficial but explicitly not essential, and I have shipped clinical mobile product at CLINET Platforms, so there is no domain gap here. The UAE government-backed context is new geography, but regulated, high-stakes, multi-stakeholder environments are not.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, assisted development and review
- **Cursor**, rapid codebase navigation and refactors
- **Lovable**, front-end prototyping without a designer
- **Framer**, design-heavy interactive mockups
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-ready decks from rough notes
- **GPT**, synthesis, user-story drafts, interview prep
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation across tools

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, Matomo, MicroStrategy, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, built alone from zero to one.

- Matches construction firms with workers; removes the headhunter from the hire through an anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment.
- WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface; LLM agents across the funnel so one operator runs the day-to-day.
- Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; full discovery, scoping, and delivery handled solo.
- Demonstrates zero-to-one product leadership and agentic workflow design relevant to a mobile-first, high-volume consumer product.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT THIS COMPANY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the delivery teams, map the existing roadmap against stated OKRs, and identify where strategic direction is unclear or where stakeholder alignment is fragile, specifically around the regulatory and compliance dependencies the posting names.

WEEK 2

Audit, prioritise, align.

Run structured sessions with engineering, design, data, and compliance leads to surface the highest-leverage gaps between current product state and the long-term vision, and produce a first draft of the multi-quarter roadmap that reflects real constraints.

WEEK 3+

Ship the direction.

Present the roadmap to senior leadership with clear KPIs tied to adoption, engagement, and retention; establish the review cadence; and begin the first cycle of customer research to validate the assumptions underneath it.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Senior Product Manager role in Abu Dhabi. The brief is specific in a way I appreciate: strategic leadership over a large-scale, regulated, consumer-facing mobile product, with delivery teams already in place and the expectation that the successful candidate will own vision, roadmap, and stakeholder alignment rather than sprint ceremonies. That is the role I have been doing, in substance if not always in title, across the last several years.

At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I owned the product roadmap for a national labour-market analytics platform used by policymakers and researchers across Germany. I held the deputy IT security officer mandate concurrently, which meant that data governance, privacy requirements, and regulatory compliance were not someone else's concern that I handed off to legal, they were mine to understand, to translate into product decisions, and to defend in front of stakeholders with sharply different interests. I reduced the time per data update by close to 75 percent by introducing Dagster and dbt, but the more important work was convincing a public-sector organisation to accept automated processes in a domain where manual sign-off had been the norm. That is the kind of stakeholder work this role demands.

At CLINET Platforms, I led a mobile patient application for iOS and Android, piloted in live hospital environments. A five-person team faced a roadmap it could not possibly deliver. My

first move was not to add capacity or push back timelines, it was to cut ruthlessly, reducing the backlog to the top ten percent of features against agreed success measures. User acceptance rose more than fivefold. I also shipped the integration with CompuGroup Medical's hospital information system, reducing the digital anamnesis process from thirty minutes to five. Both results came from the same discipline: defining what would count as success before building, and checking afterwards whether it happened.

The posting mentions the importance of balancing short-term delivery demands with long-term strategic objectives and of empowering delivery teams while maintaining product direction. At Rohde & Schwarz, I led a cross-functional team of fifteen engineers and data scientists on an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme. I redirected the product strategy mid-cycle based on instrumented workflow analysis, the beautifully designed UI-led feature recorded exactly zero clicks, so we reprioritised toward developer-code-first tooling and saw pipeline runs increase two hundred percent. Redirecting strategy with evidence rather than opinion, without undermining the team's confidence in the process, is a specific skill.

Abu Dhabi is a location I am actively targeting. I am an EU citizen, I am prepared to relocate, and I am available at short notice. I would welcome a conversation about the role and the product.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries: defence AI, public-sector analytics, healthcare mobile, insurance SaaS, and fintech. Strongest in environments where strategic direction is genuinely ambiguous, stakeholder groups have competing interests, and compliance constraints are non-negotiable rather than optional. Comfortable owning a multi-quarter roadmap while keeping delivery teams autonomous and accountable.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP and PoC definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL.

Governance and Compliance: GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, EU AI Act, AI governance, data quality and integrity.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI 2024-2025

Owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme across 15+ engineers. Redirected strategy based on workflow instrumentation, increasing pipeline runs 200%. Introduced GitOps with ArgoCD, cutting rollout time from days to 30 minutes.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Roadmap ownership for a national labour-market analytics platform. Deputy IT Security Officer. Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving ~75% of time per data update. Migrated bare-metal to containers; shipped full UI relaunch and ETL migration concurrently.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Led iOS/Android patient app in live hospital pilots. Cut backlog to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS integration, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production. Reduced time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning. POS and forecourt systems across a matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH. Regulated, secure government data platform.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals in a clinical network.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Two-sided construction staffing marketplace built solo. Anonymity-until-payment model; WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface; LLM agents across the funnel. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software for enterprise buyers. Shipped a three-layer product installable in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRI-TECH 2018-2021

Took a nanotechnology fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds. Owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse, inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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